

"A majority of the hiring for technical functions would be in the areas of AI, ML, telematics and EVs. So, it will primarily be vehicle engineering functions, telematics engineers, supply chain and logistics analysts and experts," says Yeshwinder Patial, Director of HR at MG Motor India. The carmaker has planned 600-700 additions across white- and blue-collar roles to its 2,000-strong workforce by the end of this year.

"Additional reinforcements are also required for sales managers as we sell more and also in the after-sales team of service engineers," he says, adding that there is definite shortage of these skills. Kumar adds to the list auto electric and electronics, ADAS, battery & battery management systems, automation in manufacturing especially because of EVs, and embedded software as skills in high demand which are not readily available. Some amount of hiring can be done from adjacent industries, especially for telematics and connectivity, but the Tata group company is investing in its existing workforce. "Skill reorientation of the workforce from mechanical into electrical—that's where our efforts are underway."

BFSI

As the Indian economy continues to grow rapidly, banking operations are not just on the rise but also undergoing rapid changes brought on by the digitalisation revolution. The space is also more multi-faceted than ever with retail banks, investment banks, fintech, insurance tech platforms, microfinance institutions and others, with fintech emerging as the brightest spot for hiring, according to experts.

Razorpay, for example, plans to add 700 people to its 2,200-strong workforce by March 2023. Chitbhanu Nagri, its Senior Vice President for People Operations, says high on their hiring radar are four functions—engineering, product management, sales and marketing. Specific roles include front-end and back-end engineers with data sciences and data engineering, DevOps, brand marketing, performance marketing, communications and content experts. "We

have 8-10 million merchants on our platform. We're building for scale and how intuitive our product is for users is important," he says about hiring for product and design skills. But niche roles are evolving around core domains such as people who understand banking and regulators like the RBI and NPCI, and those with underwriting capabilities. "Tighter governance around merchant onboarding means risk management professionals become important."

A good grasp of financials is crucial for HDFC Bank employees, too, even in roles like that of a relationship manager, which forms the basic block of a relationship-oriented industry like banking. "They should be able to appraise the books and do some basic credit evaluation of the businesses...

That's not easily available in bigger or smaller towns," says CHRO Razdan, adding that the MSME segment is a key growth area as the bank expands its branch footprint into the hinterlands. As a result, the bank, which opened 1,000 new branches last year, is seeing the need for back-end expansion. "We need more people in operations, credit side, finance and HR. I have had to ramp up my own team over the last 12 months because of the hiring demand." Along with MSME relationships, proficiencies in cybersecurity, credit and risk assessment and treasury dealers are highly specialised areas where it is hard to replace talent and that's where the skill gaps are, he adds.

On the other hand, Nagri says Razorpay has declined more candidates owing to cultural fitment challenges than skillset challenges. Given the rigour that goes into technical assessment, there aren't many skill gaps, "A lot of softer skills, interpersonal skills, collaboration, empathy towards each other are things we need to reinforce."



"Skills around auto electric and electronics, particularly the area of advanced driver-assistance systems, are going to have a lot of demand. Anything to do with batteries is going to be huge"

RAVINDRA KUMAR G.P., PRESIDENT & CHIEF HR OFFICER, TATA MOTORS

PHARMA & HEALTHCARE

The pandemic put the spotlight on this sector in India, which is known as the pharmacy of the